CORY A. ROSS

Chief Marketing Officer | Head of Marketing | Product Marketing, Brand, Communications & Growth | Web3, Fintech & AI

cory@coryaross.com | +1 (902) 456-4315 | LinkedIn | Twitter | Telegram | Website

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Marketing executive with 10+ years in web3, fintech, and emerging technology, from first marketing hire to CMO. Builds and scales B2B and B2C marketing functions across product marketing, brand strategy, PR, communications, organic social, SEO, newsletters, community, and events, using go-to-market (GTM) strategy to drive audience growth, product adoption, and revenue. Launched a $200M venture fund, advises portfolio companies from early stage through token launch, and leads hands-on as a player-coach. AI-fluent builder who uses AI tools and AI-assisted workflows hands-on. Deep network across Tier 1 crypto media, KOLs, exchanges, launchpads, and institutional partners.

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategy & Leadership: Go-to-Market (GTM) Strategy, Marketing Strategy, Product Marketing, Positioning & Messaging, Brand Strategy, Team Leadership, Budget Management, Agency Management, Cross-Functional Collaboration, Growth Metrics & Reporting

Growth & Audience: Audience Growth, Growth Hacking, Organic Social Media (X/Twitter, Telegram, Discord), Community Management, KOL & Influencer Marketing, Newsletter & Email Marketing, SEO, Incentive Campaigns, Demand Generation, B2B & B2C Marketing, Revenue Growth

PR, Content & Events: PR (Public Relations) & Media Relations, Communications, Crisis Communications, Reputation Management, Content Strategy, Thought Leadership, Executive Ghostwriting, Conferences & Hackathons, Public Speaking, Partnerships & Co-Marketing

Domain & Tools: Web3, DeFi, Fintech, RWA & Tokenization, Layer 1 / EVM, TGE & Token Launches, Exchanges, Institutional Investors, AI-Assisted Workflows, Gleam, Beehiiv, Figma, Google Workspace

EMPLOYMENT EXPERIENCE

Mash.fun | Chief Marketing Officer (CMO), Part-Time | July 2025 - March 2026

The first and only platform for betting on sports perps, on Solana.

- Brought in to get the marketing function on track after slow growth at launch; grew the userbase from a couple dozen to several hundred through organic social and content, with no marketing budget.
- Launched the Mash Vault, attracting well over $100,000 in deposits in a few months at a high APY (funded by a share of platform earnings), again with no marketing budget.
- Educated users on the novel "sports perps" category with product education content, including an X article from the founder's account, and verified the business account on X to increase content output and organic reach.

- Created the pre-seed pitch deck and distributed it through my personal investor network; founders and angel investors paused the project when the round missed its investment threshold (see mash.fun).

Shima Capital | Chief Marketing Officer (CMO) | July 2022 - 2026

Early-stage crypto/web3 VC with 180+ portfolio companies and a $200M fund. Currently winding down.

- Lead marketing, communications, brand strategy, content, organic social, PR, thought leadership, and event strategy for one of the most active early-stage web3 investment firms.
- Launched the $200M fund with a Blockworks exclusive and follow-on Tier 1 coverage in CoinDesk, Cointelegraph, BeInCrypto, and other major crypto publications.
- Advise portfolio companies hands-on across GTM strategy, product positioning and messaging, launch planning, community, PR, KOL campaigns, social growth, token launch readiness, and market-facing narrative.
- Built and maintain relationships with Tier 1-2 crypto KOLs, media, agencies, launchpads, and ecosystem operators across key global markets, facilitating partnerships and co-marketing.
- Created enablement playbooks, templates, and step-by-step guides that let portfolio teams run PR, influencer, content, and growth campaigns in-house.
- Scaled one portfolio project's audience from ~13k to 150k followers through growth hacking, campaign design, and social distribution improvements.
- Produced executive thought leadership, ghostwritten founder profiles, investment showcases, and press releases to build the firm's brand and authority.

Select Portfolio Company Support

Momentum | Largest DEX on Sui

- Early hands-on marketing and growth advisor as Momentum became the leading DEX on Sui; helped interview and hire its first CMO.
- Initiated early X/Twitter growth tactics toward ~350k followers, supported community development and moderator structure, and advised the external agency to align messaging, campaigns, and social execution with on-chain growth goals.
- Secured Tier 1 coverage in The Block alongside a press release.

D3 | DomainFi / Tokenized Domains

- Supported token generation event (TGE) readiness with introductions to Coinbase, CEXs, launchpads, and strategic partners.
- Introduced a key media partner for Chinese and Korean markets, driving a large-scale Asian KOL campaign.
- Initiated Web3-native advertising, PR, and educational content to broaden awareness and expand partnership and growth channels.

Goldilocks | DeFi protocol on Berachain

- Advised the rollout of Vaults and Goldilend, the flagship lending app, including product positioning, launch strategy, and content direction.

- Pushed for public product documentation to improve onboarding and explain protocol mechanics, and encouraged retaining and growing active vaults to support TVL and product stickiness.
- Shifted social from a "major-announcement-only" approach to a consistent, ecosystem-native content cadence that improved engagement and sentiment; supported community activations such as Boker Night / Bera-Poker.

Berachain

- Secured media coverage for Berachain's first major announcement, highlighting its initial $42M raise and positioning it as a flagship next-generation chain.

Tribal Finance (via Shima Capital) | Interim Executive Lead (Acting CEO / COO / CMO) | April 2024 - February 2025

- Stepped into a distressed Web3/RWA project with a token trapped since 2022, a hostile community, exchange complications, investor pressure, and broken stakeholder trust, operating as de facto CEO, COO, and CMO while a new management team took over.
- Rebuilt relationships across community, partners, exchanges, service providers, and institutional investors, including SoftBank and CB Ventures.
- Consolidated control of core operating assets, including domain, Figma, Google Workspace, AWS, Vercel, and Beehiiv.
- Replaced the community team, reinstated the newsletter, rebooted social channels, and launched regular real-name AMAs that answered hard questions live, shifting sentiment from openly hostile to cautiously constructive through transparent crisis communications.
- Secured new exchange relationships and coordinated with CoinMarketCap and CoinGecko for listings, data flows, and market visibility.
- Guided a full website rebuild and reshaped the white paper to reflect the true roadmap and go-forward plan.
- Led the process that released the token after a roughly two-year wait, letting locked-in community members and investors sell, reposition, or regain control.

Discreet Labs / Findora | Director of Marketing | July 2021 - July 2022

EVM-compatible Layer 1 using zero-knowledge proofs to enable on-chain confidentiality for stablecoins, wrapped tokens, NFTs, and DeFi.

- First senior marketing hire; led a team of 10 plus agencies across PR, growth hacking, community, reputation, and content, and covered business development (BD).
- Built a six-month marketing plan with Engineering and Product, then developed GTM strategies for the EVM launch, staking, and a $100M ecosystem grants fund; named and launched the Rialto Bridge, a cross-chain bridge between Findora and BSC.
- Designed and executed a $5M FRA token incentive campaign using Gleam, PR, educational content, how-to materials, and community activation.
- Delivered ~30k new followers, a 30x spike in website traffic, and 40-50% growth across Telegram and Discord from the Rialto launch campaign.

- Grew the X/Twitter audience from ~10k to 100k+ followers in under a year and acquired the parked @Findora handle at no cost through backchannel outreach.
- Built a content engine (Validator Spotlight, Findora Academy, technical explainers, newsletters) and hosted "Findora Fridays," a weekly live AMA with senior engineers answering unscripted community questions.
- Ran 24/7 community moderation and engagement across English and Mandarin channels.
- Created the conference strategy and budget from scratch, sponsored Consensus, hosted an IRL hackathon at ETH Amsterdam, and orchestrated two hackathons (one virtual, one in person) repurposed into YouTube content.
- Drove reputation management after negative press around the founding team, using SEO, content, agency support, and narrative control to reduce FUD and strengthen market trust.
- Hired, managed, and replaced PR, growth, and reputation agencies to maintain execution quality.

Mogul Productions | Head of Marketing | April 2021 - July 2021

Decentralized film financing and movie-based NFT platform working with well-known IP, creators, and entertainment partners.

- First official marketing hire; managed a small internal team plus a large network of contractors and agencies across community, content, PR, social, partnerships, and campaign execution.
- Built GTM plans and campaign strategies for major launches and entertainment activations.
- Orchestrated a three-hour global livestream across multiple time zones, drawing ~400k viewers and driving a $180k NFT sale.
- Executed content and distribution across social, email, owned media, and partner channels.
- Secured coverage in Forbes, Variety, Bloomberg, and other major outlets.

Peerplays Blockchain | Head of Marketing | October 2017 - April 2021

Blockchain-based gaming software developer with multiple on-chain product launches, including BookiePro, Easy5050, and Peerplays RNG.

- First marketing employee and fourth overall hire; helped scale the company to 20+ employees.
- Built brand, messaging, positioning, organic social, and GTM systems from scratch and executed GTM plans for multiple on-chain product launches.
- Added ~25,000 X/Twitter followers from a near-zero base and launched two monthly newsletters that grew combined mailing lists to 5,000+ subscribers.
- Developed segmented advertising and demand generation campaigns for BookiePro, targeting niche online communities to drive usage and on-chain activity.
- Directed branding and design guidelines for several products, and managed a small in-house team plus contractors alongside development on product-facing initiatives.